

Pixelanea — student handout

Pixel art on your computer · no account needed

Getting started

1. Open **Pixelanea** from the application menu.
2. Click **Open existing project** and choose the template file your teacher shared (`blank-starter.pixelanea`).
Or click **Start blank** to make your own canvas.
3. Pick a color from the palette on the right.
4. Click on the canvas to paint pixels.

Tools you'll use

Tool	What it does	Shortcut
Pencil	Paint pixels	B
Eraser	Fix mistakes	E
Eyedropper	Pick a color from your art	I
Undo	Undo last change	Ctrl+Z

Saving your work

1. **File** → **Save As**
2. Choose a name ending in `.pixelanea`
3. When the status bar says **All changes saved**, your file is ready to copy to USB or email

Mini challenges (pick one)

- **Icon** — 16×16 heart, star, or sword (max 4 colors)
- **Character** — 32×32 simple face
- **Animation** — 8-frame blinking eye (ask your teacher about Duplicate frames)

Need help?

- Press `?` in the editor for the full shortcut list
- Ask your teacher if the file picker doesn't open — you can type the full file path instead

Pixelanea keeps everything on your computer. Nothing is uploaded to the cloud.